

Strait of Hormuz — Maritime Security Timeline

Alert Window: Today · Generated: 2026-03-20 07:50:36

Situation Brief

THREAT LEVEL

Iran's effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz poses an immediate and high-severity threat to energy transit, significantly tightening the flow of oil and gas through this critical maritime chokepoint.

INFRASTRUCTURE RISK

The immediate threat of attacks on Gulf energy infrastructure poses a high risk to energy transit, potentially impacting flows beyond the Strait of Hormuz.

MARKET SIGNAL

WTI is at 96.59 and Brent is at 107.94.

AI-generated from deterministic classification data · 2026-03-20 07:50:36

Critical Developments (Next 24–48h Focus)

Iran's Closure of the Strait of Hormuz

The effective closure of this critical chokepoint threatens to disrupt oil and gas supply routes, impacting global markets and driving prices higher within hours as traders react to reduced availability.

Attacks on Gulf Energy Infrastructure

The heightened risk of attacks on energy infrastructure in the Gulf could lead to immediate supply disruptions, affecting not only regional producers but also global energy markets reliant on stable flows from this area.

Escalation of Military Tensions in the Gulf

Increased military activity and potential retaliatory strikes in the region raise the risk of broader conflict, which could severely disrupt energy supply chains and elevate prices rapidly as uncertainty escalates.

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Market Snapshot

As of Mar 19, 2026 17:10 Eastern Daylight Time

Market Regime: Structural Tightening (Distillate + Gas Driven)

WTI	Brent	Nat Gas
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96.59

107.94

3.17

VIX
25.5310Y
4.28Dollar
100.06

Refining Spread: +79.4 (Extreme Distillate Tightness)

SYSTEM STRESS

Jet Fuel
4.19
~176/bblCheniere (LNG)
281.87BDRY ETF
10.02

Situation Summary

Events Detected: 10

High Severity: 10

Primary Actor: Iran

Actor Concentration: 50% Iran

Dominant Closure Risk: Full

Unconfirmed Clusters: 2 cluster(s) — single source, excluded from brief

Market Regime: Structural Tightening

Event Timeline

EVENT CLUSTER — How Iran Has Effectively Closed the Strait of Hormuz

FULL

IRAN

UNKNOWN

VERIFIED

Mar 20 6:49 · HIGH · immediate · *Bloomberg.com, The World Economic Forum, The Times of Israel**Iran's effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz poses an immediate and high-severity threat to energy transit, significantly tightening the flow of oil and gas through this critical maritime chokepoint.*

3 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 1 of 4

EVENT CLUSTER — Gulf energy infrastructure attacks have more profound implications than Strait of Hormuz disruption

THREATENED

UNKNOWN

UNKNOWN

CORROBORATED

Mar 20 6:49 · HIGH · immediate · *New York Post, Gulf News, MSN*

The immediate threat of attacks on Gulf energy infrastructure poses a high risk to energy transit, potentially impacting flows beyond the Strait of Hormuz.

4 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 2 of 4

EVENT CLUSTER — Spokesperson for Iran's Revolutionary Guards killed in strike, state media reports

THREATENED

IRGC

UNKNOWN

UNVERIFIED

Mar 20 6:49 · HIGH · immediate · *New York Post, CBS News*

The killing of a spokesperson for Iran's Revolutionary Guards raises immediate and high-severity risks of closure to energy transit routes in the Strait of Hormuz, potentially tightening maritime security in the region.

2 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 3 of 4

EVENT CLUSTER — Asia snaps up most US oil in three years as Hormuz closure hits Middle East supplies

FULL

UNKNOWN

UNKNOWN

UNVERIFIED

Mar 20 6:49 · HIGH · immediate · *Nation Thailand*

The imminent closure of the Strait of Hormuz poses a high-severity risk to energy transit, significantly impacting Middle Eastern oil supplies and prompting a surge in U.S. oil purchases by Asia, indicating a tightening market.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 4 of 4

Hormuz Reference

Daily Flow: ~21M bbl crude · ~20% global LNG · 21% world oil supply

Key Exporters: Saudi Arabia, UAE, Kuwait, Iraq, Iran, Qatar (LNG)

Bypass: Saudi East-West Pipeline (~5M bbl/day) · UAE Habshan-Fujairah (~1.5M bbl/day)

Reroute: Cape of Good Hope — +15-20 days, significant cost premium

Geography: Iran controls northern shore · Oman controls southern shore · 21nm at narrowest

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About This Report

This report is generated automatically from a curated pipeline of RSS feeds, wire services, and government sources. Event clusters are formed by grouping related headlines from multiple outlets and classified by escalation level, actor, and category using deterministic rule-based logic. The Situation Brief and Critical Developments sections are AI-generated and grounded exclusively in VERIFIED and CORROBORATED clusters.

Limitations

This report does not represent a complete picture of all events in the region. Source availability, feed latency, and relevance filtering affect coverage. Single-source events may reflect early unconfirmed reporting that is later corrected or retracted. Energy market data may be delayed.

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https://petroai1492.github.io/delta/timelines/hormuz_timeline.pdf